

8.5 File Shredder

A file shredder application does pretty much what a paper shredder - used in offices to destroy sensitive documents - does. When a file is deleted, the OS just removes the link to that file from the file table, and does not actually remove them from the hard drive; this is the very reason why file recovering software are able to recover them.

A file shredder application, on the other hand, removes the link, wipes the data from the hard drive and then re-writes junk data on the same space. This makes it impossible for any recovery software to get the data back.

8.5.1 Simple File Shredder (SFS)

File shredders are extremely small applications and are also very simple to use, since there is hardly anything to understand. Just drag and drop the files you want to shred and hit the 'Delete' button!

SFS, as the name suggests, is a simple tool to get rid of sensitive data. The installer is hardly 500 KB, and installation happens before you can say 'Blink'. The UI is simple, with just 10 icons and a big drop box to drop the files to be shredded. Strong windows shell integration means right-clicking on a file gives you the option to shred the file. To avoid unauthorised use of this tool, a password can be set. Options also include setting up of the shredding level, which changes the number of times the program writes junk data to the disk - a higher level means



Simple File Shredder is an easy to use app